FUND I • VINTAGE 2026

# Beyond Utility
# Water Ventures

Pre-seed and seed stage venture fund investing in water and wastewater technologies powering the next generation of water infrastructure.

**$12.5M**
Target Fund Size

**10–20**
Target Investments

**Pre-Seed & Seed**
Stage Focus



Confidential

WHY WATER, WHY NOW

# Water infrastructure is being rebuilt from the ground up.

- Aging infrastructure across the developed world requires trillions in reinvestment over the next 25 years.
- Regulatory pressure on PFAS, lead, and emerging contaminants is creating urgent demand for new treatment technologies.
- Climate variability is driving water scarcity, flooding, and distribution challenges at an accelerating pace.
- Water utilities are increasingly open to adopting technology — a significant shift from the historically conservative sector.

**$1T+**

Estimated U.S. water infrastructure investment needed over the next 25 years (EPA & ASCE estimates).

**50-Year Horizon**

Water infrastructure will look dramatically different. The companies building that future are being founded now.

**Underserved by VC**

Water technology receives a fraction of climate-tech venture capital despite massive market opportunity.

GENERAL PARTNER

# Alex Fairhart

A career spent at every stage of the water innovation lifecycle — from academic research and PhD-stage spinouts through angel investing, consulting, and building companies across the water industry.

- **Angel Investor** — ~10 years of direct investing in water technology startups and secondary share purchases from early employees.
- **Scientist & Academic** — Research background across water treatment, infrastructure systems, and environmental science.
- **Regulatory Expertise** — Deep understanding of water quality regulations, compliance pathways, and permitting landscapes.
- **Founder & Operator** — Direct experience building and running businesses within the water sector.
- **Consultant** — Advisory work with water companies on technical diligence, market entry, and growth strategy.

### Domain-First Investing

In a specialized, relationship-driven sector, deep domain knowledge is the primary competitive advantage — both for sourcing differentiated deals and supporting founders through water-specific challenges.

### Technical Diligence

Capable of conducting rigorous technical evaluations in-house. 20–40 hours average diligence per deal, with external experts engaged when needed.

### Expert Network

Augmented by dedicated hours from expert partners, technical advisors, and industry specialists across the water and wastewater ecosystem.

INVESTMENT THESIS

# Back the founders building next-generation water infrastructure.

We invest at the earliest stages — when deep domain expertise, hands-on support, and industry access matter most.

### 70% Market

Evaluation weighted heavily toward market opportunity. Is this solving a real, large, urgent water problem? Is there regulatory tailwind?

### 30% Financials

Unit economics, believable go-to-market strategy, and documented steps toward commercial traction — even at pre-revenue stage.

### Founder-First

50–75% of investments expected to be first-time founders. We look for domain expertise, adaptability, leadership, and a strong IP strategy.

### Pre-Seed & Seed

Investing when others see too much risk. Our domain expertise lets us underwrite water-specific technology and market risk that generalist VCs cannot.

### Water & Wastewater Technologies

Treatment, monitoring, distribution, reuse, infrastructure software, digital water, and industrial process optimization.

SOURCING & DEAL ACCESS

# Differentiated access in a small, relationship-driven sector.

- **Founder Referrals** — Portfolio founders and water industry contacts as the primary source of warm deal flow.
- **University & Accelerator Networks** — PhD spinouts, incubators, and early-stage programs surfacing pre-seed opportunities.
- **VC Syndicate Relationships** — Active dealflow sharing with later-stage water and climate tech VCs.
- **Industry Events & Cold Outreach** — Conferences, trade events, and proactive sourcing of companies solving known water problems.
- **Inbound Applications** — 25–50% of deal flow arrives inbound, reflecting growing brand recognition in water tech.

**5–10%**

Funnel Conversion Rate

### Why This Matters

The water technology ecosystem is small. Founders, researchers, and operators largely know each other. In this market, relationships compound — every investment, advisory engagement, and industry interaction strengthens the sourcing flywheel.

### Co-Investment Network

Active relationships with 18+ venture firms, strategic investors, accelerators, and research networks across the water sector. Dealflow sharing partnerships enable both proprietary sourcing and syndication at scale.

DEALFLOW PARTNERSHIPS

# Co-investors, accelerators & research networks.

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| HG Ventures | Burnt Island | Suma Capital | Echo River | Skion Water | Emerald Tech |
| Archimed | BDA Partners | CRH Ventures | Aqualateral | Mazarine | Natural Ventures |
| Pure Terra | Breakthrough | Xylem Labs | Imagine H2O | BlueTech | Isle Utilities |

## Syndication Strategy

Active dealflow sharing with later-stage VCs in the water sector. Our pre-seed and seed positioning creates natural syndication and follow-on pathways with partners investing at Series A and beyond.

## Research & Scouting

Partnerships with accelerators like Imagine H2O and research networks like BlueTech Research and Isle Utilities surface early-stage companies before they reach traditional VC radar.

PORTFOLIO SUPPORT

# Hands-on partnership, not passive capital.

Weekly engagement with portfolio companies. Here's what that looks like in practice.

### Technical Diligence & R&D Support

In-house capability to evaluate water treatment chemistry, systems design, and engineering claims. Ongoing technical advisory as products move from lab to field.

### Regulatory Navigation

Deep understanding of EPA, state-level, and emerging contaminant regulations. Help founders understand compliance pathways, permitting timelines, and regulatory risk.

### Industry Introductions

Warm connections to utilities, industrial buyers, municipal decision-makers, and channel partners across the water sector. Business development that accelerates first customers.

### Fundraising

Direct introductions to follow-on investors through our co-investment network. Guidance on positioning, materials, and narrative for Series A readiness.

### Hiring & Talent

Help sourcing key hires — particularly technical talent with water industry experience, which is scarce and difficult to find through traditional channels.

### Mentorship

Founder-to-founder guidance from someone who has built and operated businesses in the water sector. Practical, not theoretical.

INVESTMENT PROCESS

# Rigorous, domain-informed diligence.

1. **Initial Screening**
   Problem clarity, water sector alignment, and founder-market fit. Quick pass/proceed decision.

2. **Team Evaluation**
   Informal references, domain expertise assessment, leadership qualities, and adaptability signals.

3. **Technical Review**
   In-person demo and deep-dive on technology, IP strategy, and competitive landscape. External experts engaged as needed.

4. **Market Validation**
   Customer willingness to pay, regulatory tailwinds, market sizing, and go-to-market credibility.

5. **Economics & Traction**
   Unit economics, documented evidence toward commercial traction, even at pre-revenue stage.

6. **Legal & Structure**
   Cap table review, IP ownership, corporate structure, and term alignment.

7. **Downside Analysis**
   What kills this company? Regulatory risk, technology risk, market timing, team risk — and mitigants for each.

### Most Common Pass

Lack of a highly believable go-to-market strategy. We need to see documented steps — not just a TAM slide — showing the founder understands their path to first revenue.

PORTFOLIO CONSTRUCTION

# Concentrated portfolio, meaningful ownership.

**10–20**
Target Investments

**$500K**
Typical Check Size

**7.5%**
Average Ownership Target

**50%**
Follow-on Reserves

### Reserve Strategy

50% of fund capital reserved for follow-on investments in best-performing portfolio companies. Allows us to maintain ownership through subsequent rounds and double down on winners.

### Deployment Timeline

Investments deployed across a ~3-year investment period, targeting 4–7 new investments per year.

| YEAR 1 | YEAR 2 | YEAR 3 | YEARS 4–7 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Initial investments 4–7 deals | Core deployment 4–7 deals | Final primary + follow-ons | Follow-on & exits |

### Exit Timeline

Typical exit horizon of 5–7 years. Water technology exits include strategic acquisitions by utilities, industrial conglomerates, and larger water technology companies, as well as follow-on venture funding to later-stage investors in our network.

FUND TERMS

# Summary of key terms.

| | |
|---|---|
| Fund Name | Beyond Utility Water Ventures Fund I |
| Vintage | 2026 |
| Target Size | $12,500,000 |
| First Close | April 10, 2026 |
| Stage | Pre-Seed & Seed |
| Sector | Water & wastewater technology |
| Geography | Primarily North America |
| Headquarters | Seattle, WA |

| | |
|---|---|
| Check Size | ~$500,000 |
| Target Ownership | ~7.5% |
| Target Deals | 10–20 |
| Follow-on Reserves | 50% of fund |
| Investment Period | ~3 years |
| Fund Life | 10 years (+ extensions) |
| Management Fee | TBD |
| Carried Interest | TBD |

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# Beyond Utility
# Water Ventures

Investing in the technologies and founders building the next generation of water infrastructure.

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